ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE N

In 1997, Clayton established the Trails and Landscape Maintenance District (District) to fund the maintenance of trails, open space, weed abatement, firebreaks, and roadside landscaping. A 10-year parcel tax was adopted, providing dedicated funding for Clayton's landscaping.

In 2007, a citizens' Blue Ribbon Committee reviewed the District's successes and challenges. The importance of Clayton's "Front Yard" was reaffirmed, and a new plan was recommended. It included a Trails and Landscape Committee (TLC), a citizen advisory body appointed by the City Council, to advise the Council and staff on maintenance, improvements, and financial matters related to the Landscape Maintenance District (LMD). Voters overwhelmingly extended the parcel tax in 2007 and 2017, ensuring continued investment in Clayton's medians, parks, trails, and open spaces.

In FY 2026-2027, residents currently pay $312.84/year per parcel and nonresidents $312.84/per acre or fraction thereof. The LMD maintains approximately 2 million square feet of roadway landscaping, 40,700 square feet of lawns and flowerbeds, 515 acres of open space, 27 miles of trails, 50 street islands and medians, and roughly 3,000 City trees. The LMD funds also support critical fire mitigation efforts in open spaces and around trails, including weed abatement. Evolving fire safety requirements are expected to increase these costs, making dedicated funding increasingly important.

Measure N includes a one-time, 10% reserve fee dedicated to capital improvements and longstanding deferred maintenance. For FY 2027-2028, residents will pay no more than $354.45/year per parcel and nonresidents $354.45/year per acre or fraction thereof, generating $1.5 million annually through 2037, with continued oversight by the TLC.

Clayton's modest General Fund cannot adequately fund public landscaping and trails. Without this dedicated funding, maintenance would rapidly decline, forever changing Clayton's beauty and character.

Please support Measure N and essential fire mitigation efforts, and preserve Clayton's landscaping, trails, open spaces, and community character for future generations.

The undersigned proponent(s) or author(s) of the Primary Argument in Favor of Measure N at the General Election for the City of Clayton, to be held on 11/3/2026, hereby state that this argument is true and correct to the best of (his/her/their) knowledge and belief.

1). Name, Title: Holly Tillman, Councilmember

Signature: Holly A.

2). Name, Title: Kim Trupiano, Councilmember

Signature: Kim Trupiano

3). Name, Title: Richard G. ENEA, Vice-MAYOR

Signature: Richard G. Enea

4). Name, Title: Jeff WAN, Mayor

Signature:

5). Name, Title: Jim DIAZ Council Member

Signature: